



ANIL CHADHA MD, ITC Hotels Ltd



ANURAAG BHATNAGAR
Whole-time Director and CEO,
The Leela Palaces, Hotels and Resorts



20,300

**THE NUMBER OF BRANDED LUXURY
HOTEL KEYS TO BE ADDED BY 2030,
IN ADDITION TO THE 35,000
ROOMS AT PRESENT**

this year it also opened the The Oberoi Vindhyavilas Wildlife Resort, Bandhavgarh.

IHCL has signed 50 Taj properties (38 in India and 12 abroad) in various stages of development that will open over the next two to three years. Of course, Taj has been growing at a phenomenal rate, having moved from 33 hotels in 2017 to 137 today.

The Postcard Hotels, which operates 11 properties in India, Sri Lanka and Bhutan with the latest, The Postcard Himalayan Willows in Leh, opening this April, has signed seven new hotels across Arunachal Pradesh, Dharmshala, Coonoor, etc.

INDUSTRY LEADERS say the timing is structural. “India’s luxury hospitality sector is at an inflection point, driven by a structural rise in wealth and strong economic momentum,” says Mandeep S. Lamba, President & CEO (South Asia), HVS ANAROCK. Morgan Stanley projects the number of high-net-worth households to quintuple to 25 million by 2035. As per the Mercedes-Benz-Hurun India Wealth Report 2025, India has 871,700 millionaire households (with a net worth of over ₹8.5 crore), up 90% from 2021. In terms of spending categories, tourism tops with 32%. “This growing pool of HNWI and UHNWI is increasingly channeling discretionary spending towards premium, experience-led travel, making luxury hotels a natural beneficiary of this shift,” adds Lamba.

While pre-pandemic most luxury hotels reported greater occupancy by international tourists, that has changed significantly in the last five years. “Pre-Covid, only 30-35% of our business came from the domestic market, but this has increased to 50% today,” says Anuraag Bhatnagar, Chief Executive Officer, The Leela Palaces, Hotels and Resorts. He adds that domestic demand for uber-luxury is also very high.

The Leela launched Arq at Pichola, a luxury villa complex on the banks of Lake Pichola in Udaipur last October. The three 5,500-sq ft villas are priced at over ₹3.5 lakh a night each and have been sold out since launch, with most of the bookings coming from Indians. “Guests today are seeking experiences and memories, and not just a luxury product per se. So, that shift has happened, and that shift is here to stay,” says Bhatnagar.

Similarly, the Kohinoor Suite at The Oberoi Amarvilas in Agra that has wall-to-wall windows for uninterrupted views of the Taj Mahal and costs approximately ₹11 lakh per night, or the 5000-sq ft Tata Suite at the Taj Mahal Palace in Mumbai, where reportedly Kim Kardashian stayed during the Anant Ambani wedding, and which costs upwards of ₹9 lakh per night are also increasingly being booked by Indians.